Pence

Every feature in the current version

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Pence is a personal spending app in pounds. You sign in and see only your own spends. It shows where the money went, and it shows an offer only when a public page or a deal board states it.

Account

- Email sign-in. A new person enters their name, monthly take-home pay, town or city, and payday.
- Settings can change those details, including whether spend reminders are wanted.
- Settings can save this phone's location, and other places typed by hand, such as a partner in Essex. Plan and the shop comparison can use any of those places. Location is not required.

Adding a spend

- Scan a receipt, pick photos from the gallery, or pick PDFs from Files. Up to 8 files. A PDF is read page by page, the first 4 pages.
- A receipt, photo or PDF, is read for the shop, date, total, and each line item. You can correct any of it before it is saved. Several receipts are checked one after another.
- A photo that is not a receipt or a list of payments is rejected.
- A photo or PDF of a bank or card list is accepted. Money in is ignored. Each money-out line can be kept or dropped, with a category.
- A wallet or bank alert can be pasted as text. Pence asks whether there is a receipt. If not, it files the spend from the alert.
- If a new receipt or statement line matches a payment already saved — same amount, same shop, and the same date — Pence asks whether to keep the saved one, replace it, or keep both. The same amount on a different date is not flagged.
- A spend can also be typed in by hand.
- Categories for a logged spend: Groceries, Household, Fashion, Entertainment, Dining, Transport, Health, Bills, Subscriptions, Personal care, Travel, Gifts, and Other.

Home

- Home shows how much of the current pay is already spent. If payday is the 25th, that pay starts on the 25th of the previous month and runs until the day before the next 25th. With no payday set, it stays a calendar month.
- How the month is pacing against last month.
- Coming up shows the next two buys Pence expects from your own habits, such as a Saturday food shop or a Friday taxi, with the likely day and the usual spend.
- Picked for you shows three deals for those habits, each with the reason it is shown. When there are none yet, it shows three posts trending across the UK instead.

- Activity on Home lists the latest spends. All Activity opens the full list.

Activity

- Every spend, grouped by day. A spend can be opened, edited, or deleted.
- The receipt image, when one was saved, stays with the spend.

Insights

- Charts for where the month went, spending by day, and the past three months side by side.
- Each category as a share of take-home, and whether it is up or down.
- What to trim, from your own numbers, plus a closer written read when asked.
- Another shop lists other big chains actually near this phone, with the distance. A price or an online offer is shown only when a page states it.

Offers for you

- Pence learns what you buy from every receipt line and every payment: the food shop, coffee, takeaways, clothes, shoes and trainers, perfume, beauty, toiletries, the pharmacy, the home, cleaning, the kids, pets, games, tickets, streaming, the gym, taxis, trains, fuel, flights, hotels, holidays, tech, gifts, and bills. Perfume bought at Boots counts as perfume, not as the pharmacy.
- For each habit and each regular shop it works out how often you buy, which weekday, whether it is just after payday, the usual time of day when a receipt shows it, and the usual spend.
- From that it expects the next buy, such as a food shop at Tesco on Saturday. Coming up lists those buys with deals for each one.
- Deals are grouped by habit. Each one says why it is shown, for example: You buy perfume about every 6 weeks. Deals near your town come first, then the shops you already use, then other shops for the same thing. About thirty at a time, then More.
- When a deal page states a percentage off, Pence shows what that is on your usual spend. It never guesses a saving.
- A product bought more than once, such as the same perfume, gets a search of its own.
- What Pence knows lists every habit. Not me hides one. Add something you buy tells Pence about a habit it has not seen yet, such as holidays. Hidden habits can be shown again.
- Deal board results load first. A wider search of public pages follows once a day and is saved for the rest of the day.
- Cards and apps for your shops lists the scheme for each shop you use, such as Tesco Clubcard, Nectar, Lidl Plus, Aldi Super 6, or Boots Advantage Card, and a note to check the ride price before you confirm.
- Hot deals, opened from Home when there are no personal picks, is the UK trending list, fifteen at a time, up to one hundred when that many exist.

Price watch

- For something you want but not at today's price: a phone, trainers, a hotel, a meal out, any product or service. Type what it is, and if you like the most you would pay and a town.
- Pence looks straight away, then every day: HotUKDeals and a wider search of public UK pages. It keeps to the same model and size, leaves out accessories, skips expired deals, and never takes a monthly contract price for the full price.
- When an offer turns up, Pence asks whether the price is right for you. Happy with this price ends the watch and keeps the offer under Done. Still too much keeps watching, and from then on only a lower price than the one turned down counts.
- A watch can be checked now, its price changed, or stopped at any time. Raising the price shows any offer Pence already saw that now fits.
- Home shows a card when Pence finds a price, and the Offers tab shows a dot. Phone alerts can be turned on at the bottom of Price watch. On iPhone, Pence must be added to the Home Screen first.
- Price watch opens from Offers, from the sidebar on a computer, and from the end of a Plan search.

Codes and links

- A discount code is shown in full with a Copy button, on every list of deals.
- The link goes to the shop where the deal is used. A deal board, Reddit, or a forum is only linked when no shop page is known.
- Expired HotUKDeals posts are left out.

Plan

- The What list on Plan stays on the lower part of the screen. Tap the dim area above it, or the phone's back button, to close it.
- What it is, grouped as Food, Home, Getting around, Shopping, You, and Life. That includes rent, gas and electricity, water, broadband, a mobile contract, TV, council tax, insurance, repairs, furniture, the garden, fuel, parking, a car, a bike, driving lessons, a phone, fashion, gifts, health, personal care, a gym, sport such as a pitch or court, entertainment, hobbies, kids, childcare, pets, education, subscriptions, a wedding or party, moving house, charity, and something else.
- A UK plan stays on what was asked for. Deals in the named town come first, then nationwide deals for the same thing. More continues until that list runs out.
- A wider search of public pages follows. It is slow the first time. The same plan on the same day is saved and returns faster. A code or a price is shown only when that page prints it.
- Not the price you want? opens Price watch with the item and budget filled in.

Deal boards

- Offers come from anywhere public and legal in the UK: shop sites, Google, Reddit, forums, HotUKDeals, and other UK deal pages. Slickdeals is not used.
- LatestDeals, MoneySavingExpert, Groupon, Wowcher, and VoucherCodes are not connected. A person can open them in a browser, but those sites block the app from reading the deals.

- The wider offer search can still land on a deal site, Reddit, or a forum when that search actually opens the page.

Bank

- Not a live bank connection. Google Pay, Apple Pay, PayPal, and Amex are not read automatically.
- You can paste or upload a CSV or a copied statement. A photo or PDF of a statement can also be added from Add. Duplicate lines are skipped.
- A live bank connection would be a separate Open Banking approval. That is not switched on.

Alerts

- A pasted wallet alert waits until it is filed or dismissed. That inbox is not in the bottom bar.

How you move around

- The bottom bar is Home, Plan, Add, Insights, and Offers. Price watch opens from Offers.
- Activity on Home is the latest spends, with All Activity opening the full list. Settings is on Home. Bank import is in Settings.